

The Apex Archive — Store Owner Handoff Checklist

1 Confirm your Shopify login

- ☐ You already have a Shopify account — just send me the email address it's under, so I can add you to the store and start the ownership transfer.

Why: I use your account's email to send the staff invite and transfer ownership to you.

2 Accept the store

- ☐ Accept the **staff invite** Shopify sends to your existing account.
- ☐ Accept the **ownership transfer** — this makes you the official store owner.

Why: once you're the owner, the money, taxes, and account are all in your name (not mine).

Keeping me on (so I can help you): after the transfer I'll stay on your store as a staff member — or I can set up free **collaborator access** through my Shopify Partner account — so I can jump in whenever you need changes or run into something. Just keep me added / approve the access request; you can remove it anytime.

3 Put your billing on the account

- ☐ **Settings** → **Plan** → confirm the plan and add **your** payment method (card).

Why: the monthly Shopify subscription bills the owner — that's you now.

4 Turn on payments

- ☐ **Settings** → **Payments** → **Activate Shopify Payments** → enter your business info, tax ID, and **bank account** (this is where your sales money is deposited).
- ☐ (Optional) Add **PayPal** as a second checkout button.
- ☐ (Optional) Toggle on **Shop Pay / Apple Pay / Google Pay** and **Shop Pay Installments** (buy-now-pay-later).

Option	What customers can use	Rough cost
Shopify Payments (main)	All major cards + Shop Pay + Apple/Google Pay	~2.4–2.9% + 30¢ / sale
PayPal (optional)	PayPal balance + PayPal-processed cards	~3.49% + 49¢ / sale

Recommended: Shopify Payments as your primary, with PayPal added as a backup button.

5 Set your store email to ApexCardArchive@gmail.com

- ☐ **Settings** → **Notifications** → **Sender email** → enter **ApexCardArchive@gmail.com**.
- ☐ **Settings** → **Store details** → **Store contact email** → set the same address.

⚠ **Important:** after entering the new email, Shopify sends a **verification link to the ApexCardArchive@gmail.com inbox**. Open that email and click the link — the address will **not** start receiving anything until you do.

*Why: this is where your **Contact form** and **Custom Order form** submissions are delivered. (Newsletter / "Join our email list" signups don't go to an inbox — they appear automatically in your **Customers** list inside Shopify.)*

6 Connect your domain — TheApexArchive.com

Your domain is registered at **GoDaddy**, so the DNS changes happen there.

- ☐ In Shopify: **Settings** → **Domains** → **Connect existing domain** → enter **theapexarchive.com**.
- ☐ In **GoDaddy** → **Manage DNS**, set these records (delete any old parking/forwarding records that conflict):
 - A record – Host @ → 23.227.38.65
 - AAAA record – Host @ → 2620:0127:f00f:5::
 - CNAME record – Host **www** → shops.myshopify.com
- ☐ Back in Shopify → **Verify connection** (usually works within a couple hours, up to 48).
- ☐ Set **theapexarchive.com** as your **primary domain** and turn on "**Redirect all traffic to this domain.**"

Why: this makes your store load at your own web address, with a secure padlock (Shopify adds the SSL certificate automatically).

7 Go live

- ☐ **Online Store** → **Preferences** → **uncheck the password protection** when you're ready for real customers.

8 Test before you announce it

- ☐ Visit **https://theapexarchive.com** — it loads with a padlock (secure).
- ☐ Build a cabinet → **Add to cart** → check out → confirm the price is correct. Place one small **test order**, then **refund** it from the Orders page.
- ☐ Submit a quick **test message** through the Contact form → confirm it arrives at ApexCardArchive@gmail.com.

Good to know

- **Configured cabinets charge the exact price automatically** — the configurator is wired to real product pricing, so checkout always matches what the customer designed. No manual quotes.
- **Extra Apex Backstops** are sold in packs of 12 (\$10/pack) and add to the order automatically.
- **Newsletter subscribers** build your Customers list inside Shopify — you can email them later with Shopify Email or a tool like Mailchimp.